

World Day Against Cyber Censorship: RSF unveils new US room in its Minecraft Uncensored Library

To mark World Day Against Cyber Censorship on March 12, Reporters Without Borders (RSF) has opened a new room in the Uncensored Library, a virtual library within Minecraft, the world's best selling videogame, that highlights the growing obstacles to press freedom and freedom of information in the United States. The library, which is accessible via Minecraft, was created as a loophole for journalists to disseminate articles censored in their home countries.

The new US room focuses on the more subtle, less direct methods of attacking press freedom and freedom of information that are currently wielded by the US government and other established democracies. Although there is no systematic state censorship in the US, the Trump administration has [targeted independent media and reporting critical of it](#) since taking office in January 2025. Journalists have been arrested and had their homes raided, access to public information has been restricted, government webpages and data have been deleted, disfavored media have been excluded from press conferences, and the administration continues to foster an increasingly hostile climate toward the press that undermines transparency and encourages self-censorship.

“The point of the Uncensored Library has always been to highlight the stories that are silenced by repressive states. But often, suppressing stories takes a less overt form than direct censorship. RSF wants to call attention to the subtler attacks on media freedom underway in the United States to remind people that fully authoritarian regimes do not have a monopoly on press freedom violations. Democracies must be on guard against these tactics to prevent backsliding.”

Clayton Weimers, Executive Director
RSF North America

Among other things, the US room documents government websites that have been removed by US authorities, offers analyses of the state of press freedom, and highlights structural developments, such as the increasing pressure the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) is putting on media companies and President Donald Trump's abusive lawsuits against media outlets. Visitors to the room can also view a political cartoon by Pulitzer Prize winner Ann Telnaes that the Washington Post refused to print—an incident that sparked a debate about the newspaper's editorial independence. Among other things, the cartoon shows Washington Post owner Jeff Bezos kneeling before Donald Trump.

So far, the Uncensored Library features journalism from Egypt, Belarus, Brazil, Eritrea, Iran, Mexico, Russia, Saudi Arabia and Vietnam. While independent news portals and online newspapers are blocked in many autocratic states, Minecraft is freely accessible almost everywhere. To read the censored articles — which appear as books in the library — users only need internet access to the computer game. The texts are available in English and in the authors' native languages.

New articles in the Egypt, Belarus, Russia and Iran rooms

In addition to the new USA room, there is now fresh content in the Uncensored Library, namely in the sections on Egypt, Belarus, Russia, and Iran. The Iran room has been

supplemented with a text by journalist Elahe Mohammadi, one of the most prominent voices in the country's journalism industry. She was the only one to report on the funeral of Jina Mahsa Amini, the young Kurdish woman who died in September 2022 at the hands of the Iranian morality police — and [was imprisoned](#) for her reporting. Visitors to the Uncensored Library can now read an article she wrote describing the harsh conditions she experienced in the notorious Evin Prison.

In the Egypt room, visitors will find two new articles from *MadaMasr*. Since 2013, the news site has been reporting on corruption and security issues – without ceding to intimidation by the repression of the Sisi dictatorship. Since May 2017, the *MadaMasr* website has been blocked in the country.

The Russia section has been expanded with more than 20 articles from various exiled media outlets. This copious new content shows that, despite comprehensive internet and information censorship by the Russian authorities, independent Russian journalism continues to exist – albeit in exile. The texts were selected with the support of the Russian Independent Media Archive, which brings together [articles from around 150 independent Russian media outlets](#) published in the last 25 years.

Six new articles by exiled journalists have been added to the Belarus section, including several investigative reports on corruption and the circumvention of EU sanctions. The room also underscores the massive political repression in the country, and users can now read a detailed interview by Maryna Zolatava with Maria Kalesnikava, one of the leading opposition figures during the mass protests in 2020. Reading or distributing these articles can be prosecuted in Belarus and lead [to long prison sentences](#).

A team of 24 experts from Blockworks, a company specialising in Minecraft, spent three months building the virtual library. In the entrance hall, visitors can learn about the state of press freedom in 180 countries. Since its opening in 2020, the library has been visited over one million times and its “books” have been read 10 million times.

Find out more about the Uncensored Library: <https://uncensoredlibrary.com/en>